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Microsoft prices its contact-centre AI by the conversation. Sierra says its recurring revenue passed $400 million.

Weekly summary · 2 November 2026

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MICROSOFT PRICES

Microsoft prices its contact-centre AI by the conversation.

- Microsoft's Copilot Credits guide, dated November 2026, gives "rough planning estimates" for Contact Center Intelligence, in public preview. Microsoft sells it on top of other vendors' contact centres.
- Microsoft estimates its Customer Assist Agent at 2 to 5 credits for a short chat, 10 to 15 for a voice call with lookups, and 20 to 25 for a long voice flow.
- Microsoft puts live coaching at 10 to 20 credits per turn, and scoring a finished conversation at 5 to 10 credits.
- Microsoft lists pay-as-you-go credits at $0.01 each. By our arithmetic, a medium voice call costs about $0.10 to $0.15 at list price, and coaching $0.10 to $0.20 per turn.
- Microsoft said on 21 October that live coaching and help for human agents are "available soon". By our reading, the guide prices them before they ship.

> Our view: buyers now get a cost per conversation for Microsoft's AI running beside another vendor's per-seat contact centre. On a long call, live coaching could cost more than the AI agent itself.

SOURCES Microsoft, Copilot Credits guide (November 2026) · Microsoft, 21 Oct

MICROSOFT RESULTS

Microsoft’s results: seats plus consumption.

- Microsoft’s chief executive, Satya Nadella, said on 28 October: “Our business model is expanding from per-seat subscriptions to include consumption”.
- He said the number of Copilot customers paying through usage billing “grew over 75 percent over the quarter”.
- Microsoft now reports Dynamics 365 inside a new “Industry solutions cloud” line, with LinkedIn’s hiring and sales tools and its healthcare cloud. That line grew 10%.
- In July, Microsoft reported Dynamics 365 alone growing 13%. The two figures do not cover the same products.
- Its finance chief, Amy Hood, said “bookings trends continued to moderate”. The call transcript does not mention the contact centre.

> Our view: investors can no longer see whether Microsoft’s contact-centre push moves Dynamics 365 growth. Its roadmap and price guides are now the main public evidence.

SOURCES Microsoft, results call and filing, 28 Oct · Microsoft, results call, 29 Jul

SIERRA

Sierra says its annual recurring revenue passed $400 million.

- Sierra wrote on 30 October that it hit “$400M+ in ARR”, adding more than $150 million in the third quarter. ARR means annual recurring revenue.
- These are Sierra’s own, unaudited figures. Sierra says it took five months to double from $200 million to $400 million.
- Sierra restated that customers “pay for outcomes”, naming loans refinanced, claims paid and sales closed as examples.
- Sierra launched a Compliance Console for AI agents’ outbound calls on 28 October. It sets contact windows, frequency limits, opt-outs and disclosures, Sierra says.
- Sierra joined Google Cloud Marketplace on 26 October, so qualifying purchases count toward Google Cloud commitments, Sierra says.

> Our view: Sierra’s examples are moving from answering service contacts to outbound sales and collections. Its revenue figures remain its own.

SOURCES Sierra, 26, 28 and 30 Oct

FIN PRICES

Fin tightens what counts as a paid outcome.

- Fin's price page still charges $0.99 per outcome. Since 25 October it has added voice "via sales at $1.99 per voice outcome".
- The page now says that if the conversation is later reopened, "the outcome is refunded".
- It also says that if Fin cannot help, "or if at any point the customer asks to speak to a human, you pay nothing".
- Copilot, Fin's assistant for human agents, is now listed at $29 per agent a month billed annually, or $35 monthly. On 25 October the page showed $35 per user.

> Our view: the main per-outcome price list now favours the buyer on refunds and human requests. That answers a common objection that outcome prices pay for silence.

SOURCES Fin, price page, 2 Nov

THE BUYER

Comcast’s layoff notices add up to 994 roles, by our sum, most at its head office.

- Comcast is laying off 634 employees at its Philadelphia headquarters from 31 December, the Philadelphia Inquirer reports, citing the state notice.
- The Inquirer reports further notices for 119 roles in New Jersey, 159 in Washington state and 82 in California. By our sum, that is 994 roles.
- In Washington, “Construction jobs are the largest group”, MyNorthwest reports. The only customer-service roles it names are “customer experience supervisors”.
- Comcast plans more than 1,100 new positions, including more than 500 in Philadelphia, the Inquirer reports, citing the notice.
- Comcast’s statement says it is “fundamentally redesigning our organization”. As quoted, it does not mention AI.

> Our view: on 22 October Comcast tied lower contact volume to its AI suppliers. The first noticed cuts fall mostly on other functions. State notices cover only larger cuts, so this total is a minimum.

SOURCES Philadelphia Inquirer, 30 Oct · MyNorthwest, 29 Oct · Deadline, 22 Oct

THE SCHEDULE

Scheduling: AI suggests, planners still decide.

- Talkdesk began rolling out AI suggestions to move agents' breaks on 29 October, based on live queue conditions, its release notes say.
- Planners accept or reject each suggestion, or accept all at once for a team, Talkdesk says. It lists the feature as a preview for selected customers.
- Assembled advertised a job on 27 October for an AI agent that "recommends or takes action". It is a hiring plan, not a product.
- Microsoft's two scheduling alerts due in October were still "In development" on 2 November, its roadmap shows. Its self-acting Intraday Agent is still listed for March 2027.
- Talkdesk, Assembled and Webex each added or previewed shift bidding within eight days, their release notes and blog show.

> Our view: the shipped frontier is software that drafts schedule changes for a planner to approve in bulk. As far as we can tell, no tracked tool yet acts by itself when demand shifts.

SOURCES Talkdesk, 29 Oct · Assembled, 27 and 29 Oct · Microsoft roadmap, 2 Nov · Webex, 30 Oct

AI AGENTS AS STAFF

AI agents get planned and scored like staff.

- RingCentral says its RingCX contact centre now forecasts staffing “across AI and human agent capacity together”, and scores AI agents “against the same rubric used for human agents”.
- RingCentral showed both at a trade show on 28 October, with no ship date or price.
- Webex added reporting on AI agents’ containment, escalation and error rates on 26 October, its release notes say.
- A Microsoft roadmap entry added on 28 October plans quality checks for AI agents that “Detect hallucinations, failed verifications, policy violations, and escalation drivers”, due in November.
- Salesforce says it added evaluations, a “Kill Switch” and hard spending limits to Agent Fabric, its control layer for AI agents, on 27 October.

> Watch: whether Microsoft’s quality checks for AI agents ship in November.

SOURCES RingCentral, 28 Oct · Webex, 26 Oct · Microsoft roadmap, 2 Nov · Salesforce, 27 Oct

THE RULES

New York City moves its bot-rule hearing to 18 December.

- New York City's rules website now lists the hearing on its proposed automated customer service rule for 18 December. On 25 October it showed 19 November.
- The same page says comments close on 18 December. The notice itself still prints 19 November, and the proposal's content is unchanged.
- Colorado's Attorney General held the hearing on its proposed automated-decision rules on 26 October. No final rule has been filed; the target date is still 1 January 2027.
- Industry groups, including the US Chamber of Commerce, asked for changes and a delay. Consumer groups asked for stronger rules.
- We found no enforcement of the EU ban on emotion recognition at work. The UK has still not responded to its workplace monitoring consultation.

> Our view: the rule cannot be adopted before the hearing, so the earliest adoption moves back by a month. Watch: 18 December.

SOURCES NYC Rules, 2 Nov · Colorado, 27 Oct · US Chamber, 26 Oct · European Commission · GOV.UK

SOURCES

Sources behind this week's news.

Company announcements, official records and reporting cited on these slides:

COMPANY ANNOUNCEMENTS

Microsoft · Sierra · Fin · Talkdesk · Assembled · Webex · RingCentral · Salesforce

OFFICIAL RECORDS AND TRADE BODIES

New York City (rules site) · Colorado (Attorney General) · US Chamber (business group) · European Commission · GOV.UK (UK government)

PRESS REPORTING

Philadelphia Inquirer · MyNorthwest · Deadline

Source links are in the full weekly summary. Full claim-by-claim citations on request.

FULL DISCLOSURE

Microsoft prices its AI by the conversation. Sierra says it passed $400 million in recurring revenue.

Microsoft published per-conversation credit estimates for the contact-centre AI it sells on rivals' platforms. Sierra's own, unaudited figures put its annual recurring revenue above $400 million. Our view: on a long call, live coaching could cost more than the AI agent itself.

→ Read the full report

productbeacon.agency/research/state-of-wem-2026

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